

D219

Scholarship in Nursing Practice

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A nurse committee at a 400-bed teaching hospital is choosing evidence for a new fall-prevention protocol. The committee chair has published two articles on falls. Which source gives the strongest level of evidence?

- A. A systematic review and meta-analysis of randomized controlled trials.
- B. The committee chair's expert opinion.
- C. A large descriptive survey of nurses' fall practices.
- D. A single well-designed randomized controlled trial.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A nurse on a 30-bed orthopedic unit asks: In adult patients after hip replacement, does scheduled ice therapy compared with as-needed ice therapy reduce pain scores within 48 hours? Her unit manager supports the project. What is the C in this PICOT question?

- A. As-needed ice therapy
- B. Within 48 hours
- C. Pain scores
- D. Scheduled ice therapy

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which PICOT element is missing? "In older adults with heart failure, does daily telehealth monitoring reduce 30-day readmissions?"

- A. Outcome
- B. Time
- C. Comparison
- D. Intervention

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A nurse researcher at a rural clinic with limited staff interviews 12 new mothers about their experience of breastfeeding after cesarean birth and identifies recurring themes. The clinic opened in 2019. What type of research is this?

- A. Meta-analysis
- B. Quantitative, because 12 participants were counted
- C. Quantitative experimental research
- D. Qualitative research

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A research team at a well-funded academic medical center wants to enroll residents of a memory care unit in a study of a new music program. Several residents have moderate dementia. The music program is popular with families. What must happen before these residents are enrolled?

- A. Families' approval of the music program is enough.
- B. No consent is needed for any low-risk study.
- C. The unit's staff nurse signs consent for all residents.
- D. IRB approval and informed consent from each resident's legally authorized representative, with the resident's assent when possible.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A study at three community hospitals compared two wound dressings in 240 patients. Healing time was 2 days shorter with dressing A ($p = 0.03$). The study was funded by a nursing foundation. Using $\alpha = 0.05$, how should the nurse read the result?

- A. Not significant, because 0.03 is less than 0.05.
- B. It proves dressing A is better for every patient.
- C. There is a 3% chance that dressing A works.
- D. The difference is statistically significant; it is unlikely to be due to chance alone.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A study reports $p = 0.20$ with $\alpha = 0.05$. What is the correct conclusion?

- A.** It proves the two treatments are identical.
- B.** No statistically significant difference was found; the null hypothesis is not rejected.
- C.** Significant, because 0.20 is larger than 0.05.
- D.** There is an 80% chance the intervention works.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A manager on a 24-bed unit that recently passed its Joint Commission survey reviews call-light response times (minutes) for five patients: 2, 3, 3, 4, 28. Which measure best represents the typical response time?

- A.** Mean, 8 minutes
- B.** Median, 3 minutes
- C.** Range, 26 minutes
- D.** Maximum, 28 minutes, since the worst case always matters most

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Six patients' lengths of stay are 2, 4, 5, 7, 9, and 30 days. What is the median?

- A.** 9.5 days
- B.** 28 days
- C.** 6 days
- D.** 5 days

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

In a study at a hospital known for its Magnet designation, nurses randomly assign post-op patients to walking within 6 hours or standard walking at 24 hours, then compare length of stay. The research team includes a physical therapist. What is the dependent variable?

- A.** Length of stay
- B.** Timing of first walk
- C.** The physical therapist's involvement
- D.** 6 hours

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A study measures whether nurses' hours of sleep before a shift affect their medication error rates. What is the independent variable?

- A.** The nurses
- B.** Both, since they are correlated
- C.** Hours of sleep
- D.** Medication error rate

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A nurse notices that hand hygiene compliance on her unit is 70%. The unit has 22 beds and a new manager. She plans to apply a reminder strategy already proven in the literature and track her unit's monthly compliance. What kind of project is this?

- A.** A research study producing generalizable knowledge
- B.** A quality improvement project
- C.** A literature review
- D.** Research, because any data collection counts as research

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A nurse committee at a ~~400-bed teaching hospital~~ is choosing evidence for a new fall-prevention protocol. ~~The committee chair has published two articles on falls.~~ Which source gives the strongest level of evidence?

Target word: highest level of evidence **Decides:** Pooled RCTs outrank any single study or opinion.

A	Correct	Top of the evidence hierarchy.
B	Camouflage	Publications do not raise expert opinion above the lowest level.
C	Confusion set	Descriptive designs rank low regardless of size.
D	Adjacent category	Strong, but one level below a systematic review of RCTs.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A nurse ~~on a 30-bed orthopedic unit~~ asks: In adult patients after hip replacement, does scheduled ice therapy compared with as-needed ice therapy reduce pain scores within 48 hours? ~~Her unit manager supports the project.~~ What is the C in this PICOT question?

Target word: comparison element **Decides:** The comparison follows “compared with.”

A	Correct	It is what the intervention is compared against.
B	Wrong stem number	That is the time frame (T).
C	Adjacent category	That is the outcome (O).
D	Confusion set	That is the intervention (I).

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

Which PICOT element is missing? “In older adults with heart failure, does daily telehealth monitoring reduce 30-day readmissions?”

Target word: find the missing element **Decides:** Nothing is named for the intervention to be compared against.

A	Confusion set	Readmissions is the outcome.
B	Wrong stem number	“30-day” supplies the time frame.
C	Correct	No alternative to telehealth monitoring is stated.
D	Adjacent category	Daily telehealth monitoring is the intervention.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A nurse researcher at a rural clinic ~~with limited staff~~ interviews 12 new mothers about their experience of breastfeeding after cesarean birth and identifies recurring themes. ~~The clinic opened in 2019.~~ What type of research is this?

Target word: research type **Decides:** Interviews analyzed for themes about lived experience.

A	Adjacent category	A meta-analysis pools results of other studies.
B	Wrong stem number	Counting participants does not make a study quantitative.
C	Confusion set	No variable is manipulated or measured numerically.
D	Correct	Explores experience and meaning through words and themes.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A research team at a ~~well-funded~~ academic medical center wants to enroll residents of a memory care unit in a study of a new music program. Several residents have moderate dementia. ~~The music program is popular with families.~~ What must happen before these residents are enrolled?

Target word: ethical requirement **Decides:** Participants may lack capacity to consent.

A	Camouflage	Popularity is not consent to research.
B	Absolute language	Low risk does not remove consent and review requirements.
C	Adjacent category	Staff are not legally authorized representatives.
D	Correct	Protects a vulnerable group under respect for persons.

6. Answer D Concept 5

A study ~~at three community hospitals~~ compared two wound dressings in 240 patients. Healing time was 2 days shorter with dressing A ($p = 0.03$). ~~The study was funded by a nursing foundation.~~ Using $\alpha = 0.05$, how should the nurse read the result?

Target word: interpret p vs. α **Decides:** $0.03 < 0.05$.

A	Inverted operation	Flips the rule: significance requires p below α .
B	Absolute language	Significance is about the group result, not proof for each patient.
C	Confusion set	p is the probability of data this extreme if there were no real difference.
D	Correct	p is below α .

7. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A study reports $p = 0.20$ with $\alpha = 0.05$. What is the correct conclusion?

Target word: non-significant result **Decides:** $0.20 > 0.05$.

A	Absolute language	Failing to find a difference is not proof of no difference.
B	Correct	p is above α .
C	Inverted operation	A larger p means weaker evidence against the null.
D	Confusion set	p is not the probability that the treatment works.

8. Answer B Concept 6

A manager on a 24-bed unit ~~that recently passed its Joint Commission survey~~ reviews call-light response times (minutes) for five patients: 2, 3, 3, 4, 28. Which measure best represents the typical response time?

Target word: best typical value with an outlier **Decides:** 28 is an outlier that distorts the mean.

A	Adjacent category	$40 \div 5 = 8$, pulled up by the single 28.
B	Correct	The middle value of 2, 3, 3, 4, 28 is 3 and ignores the outlier's size.
C	Confusion set	Range shows spread, not the typical value.
D	Absolute language	The question asks for the typical time, not the worst.

9. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

Six patients' lengths of stay are 2, 4, 5, 7, 9, and 30 days. What is the median?

Target word: median with an even count **Decides:** Average the two middle values, 5 and 7.

A	Adjacent category	That is the mean: $57 \div 6$.
B	Confusion set	That is the range ($30 - 2$).
C	Correct	$(5 + 7) \div 2 = 6$.
D	Dropped element	Takes only one of the two middle values.

10. Answer A Concept 7

In a study at a hospital ~~known for its Magnet designation~~, nurses randomly assign post-op patients to walking within 6 hours or standard walking at 24 hours, then compare length of stay. ~~The research team includes a physical therapist.~~ What is the dependent variable?

Target word: outcome measured **Decides:** Length of stay is what is compared after assignment.

A	Correct	The outcome that depends on the assigned walking schedule.
B	Inverted operation	That is the independent variable being assigned.
C	Camouflage	Team membership is not a study variable.
D	Wrong stem number	One level of the independent variable.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A study measures whether nurses' hours of sleep before a shift affect their medication error rates. What is the independent variable?

Target word: independent variable **Decides:** Sleep is the presumed cause.

A	Adjacent category	That is the population, not a variable.
B	Confusion set	Correlation does not make both variables independent.
C	Correct	The factor thought to influence the outcome.
D	Inverted operation	That is the dependent (outcome) variable.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A nurse notices that hand hygiene compliance on her unit is 70%. ~~The unit has 22 beds and a new manager.~~ She plans to apply a reminder strategy already proven in the literature and track her unit's monthly compliance. What kind of project is this?

Target word: project type **Decides:** Local improvement using a known strategy.

A	Adjacent category	She is not testing a new hypothesis for wider use.
B	Correct	Improves a local process with proven methods.
C	Confusion set	She is acting on evidence, not only summarizing it.
D	Absolute language	QI also collects data without being research.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	4	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Hierarchy of evidence	Systematic reviews and meta-analyses of RCTs rank highest; single RCTs next; descriptive studies and expert opinion rank lowest.	Trusting a respected expert or one large survey over pooled trials.	“Strongest evidence” and a list of source types.
2	PICOT questions	Population, Intervention, Comparison, Outcome, Time — each element is a distinct part of the question.	Mixing up the intervention and the comparison, or the outcome and the time.	A clinical question and “which element is...”
3	Qualitative vs. quantitative research	Qualitative explores experiences and meanings through words and themes; quantitative measures variables with numbers and statistics.	Calling a study quantitative because participants were counted.	Interviews and themes vs. measures and tests.
4	Research ethics	Studies need IRB approval and informed consent; people who lack capacity need consent from a legally authorized representative plus their assent when possible.	Treating low-risk or popular programs as exempt from consent.	Vulnerable participants such as people with dementia, children, or prisoners.
5	Statistical significance	If $p < \alpha$ (usually 0.05), the result is statistically significant — unlikely due to chance alone; it does not prove the effect for every patient.	Reading p as the chance the treatment works, or flipping the comparison.	A p-value and an alpha level.
6	Measures of central tendency	The median resists outliers; the mean is pulled by extreme values.	Reporting the mean when one extreme value distorts it.	One value far from the rest.
7	Independent vs. dependent variables	The independent variable is manipulated or compared; the dependent variable is the outcome measured.	Swapping cause and effect.	“Does X affect Y?”
8	Research vs. QI vs. EBP	Research creates new generalizable knowledge; QI improves a local process with known methods; EBP applies best evidence to practice.	Calling any data collection research.	Local unit, proven strategy, tracking results.

Course scope (public description): Scholarship in Nursing Practice helps students understand how research can enhance nursing practice and patient care outcomes. In this course, students will be introduced to the fundamentals of evidence-based practice, including data analysis, ethical considerations in research, and literature review, which they will apply in their clinical rotations which may or may not start in this course. By completing this course, students will develop the proficiency and self-assurance needed to emerge as leaders in the healthcare setting, contributing to the advancement of patient care and the nursing profession.